

## Mushroom Risotto (Risotto ai Funghi)

Mushroom Risotto is a classic Northern Italian dish celebrated for its incredibly creamy texture, achieved without using much cream. The secret lies in the slow, patient process of cooking starchy Arborio rice, allowing it to gradually release its starches while absorbing flavorful broth.

This dish is the epitome of Italian comfort food—warm, rich, and deeply satisfying.

Keep reading below for a traditional mushroom risotto recipe that will guide you through creating a perfect, velvety risotto with an intense, earthy mushroom flavor.

### Recipe

| Prep Time: | Cook Time: | Serves:  |
|------------|------------|----------|
| 20 minutes | 35 minutes | 4 people |

### Ingredients

- 6 cups (approx. 1.5 liters) chicken or vegetable broth
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tbsp butter
- 400g mushrooms, sliced (cremini or a mix)
- 1 shallot (or  $\frac{1}{2}$  onion), finely chopped
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- $1\frac{1}{2}$  cups (300g) Arborio rice
- $\frac{1}{2}$  cup (120 ml) dry white wine (like Pinot Grigio or Sauvignon Blanc)
- 1 cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese
- 2 tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- Salt and freshly ground black pepper, to taste

### Instructions

#### 1. Prepare the Broth and Mushrooms

1. Pour the broth into a medium saucepan and bring it to a simmer over low heat. Keep it warm throughout the cooking process.
2. In a large skillet or Dutch oven, heat 1 tbsp of olive oil over medium-high heat. Add the mushrooms and cook until they have released their water and are nicely browned (about 5-7 minutes).
3. Season the mushrooms with a pinch of salt and pepper, then remove them from the pan and set aside.

#### 2. Start the Risotto

1. In the same skillet, add the remaining 1 tbsp of olive oil and 1 tbsp of butter. Reduce the heat to medium.
2. Add the chopped shallot and sauté until soft and translucent, about 3-4 minutes.
3. Stir in the minced garlic and cook for another minute until fragrant.
4. Add the Arborio rice to the pan. Stir constantly for about 2 minutes to toast the grains. Each grain should be coated and the edges will look translucent.

### 3. Cook the Risotto

1. Pour in the white wine to deglaze the pan, scraping up any browned bits from the bottom. Let it simmer until the wine is almost completely absorbed.
2. Add one ladleful of the warm broth to the rice. Stir continuously until the liquid is almost fully absorbed.
3. Continue adding the broth one ladle at a time, stirring frequently. **Wait for each addition to be absorbed before adding the next.** This slow process is key to a creamy risotto.
4. After about 15-20 minutes, the rice should be tender with a slight bite (*al dente*).

### 4. Finish and Serve

1. Stir the cooked mushrooms back into the risotto.
2. Remove the skillet from the heat. Stir in the grated Parmesan cheese and chopped parsley.
3. Taste and adjust seasoning with salt and pepper as needed. The risotto should be creamy and flow slightly, not stiff.

### Serving Tip

Serve the risotto immediately in warm bowls, as it can become thick and starchy upon sitting. Garnish with an extra sprinkle of Parmesan cheese, a drizzle of good quality olive oil, or more fresh parsley. It pairs beautifully with a glass of the same white wine used in the recipe.